GASOLINE TANK FILLER NECK GROMMET REPLACEMENT

AFFECTED VEHICLES: CERTAIN 1998 THROUGH 2000 BI-FUEL CONTOUR

SERVICE PROCEDURE

1. Relieve gasoline fuel system pressure. Be sure the bi-fuel switch is in the GASOLINE mode first, then remove the fuel pump relay from the power distribution box under the hood. Start and run the engine until it runs out of fuel (engine stalls) then crank the engine a few more seconds to make sure no residual gasoline fuel pressure is left. Reinstall the relay. See Figure 1.

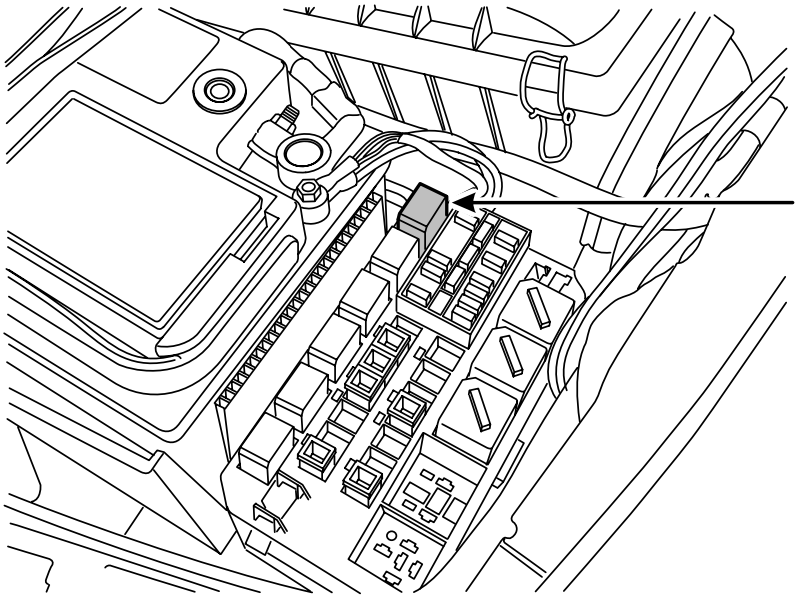


FIGURE 1

2. Install memory saver and disconnect the battery ground cable.
3. Drain the gasoline from the tank, using a suitable tanker and a 3/8-inch hose long enough to reach down the filler neck to the fuel tank. The end of the hose must be trimmed to a point to allow for insertion into the tank.
4. Raise and support the vehicle on a hoist.

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5. Disconnect the fuel filter outlet tube. See Figure 2.

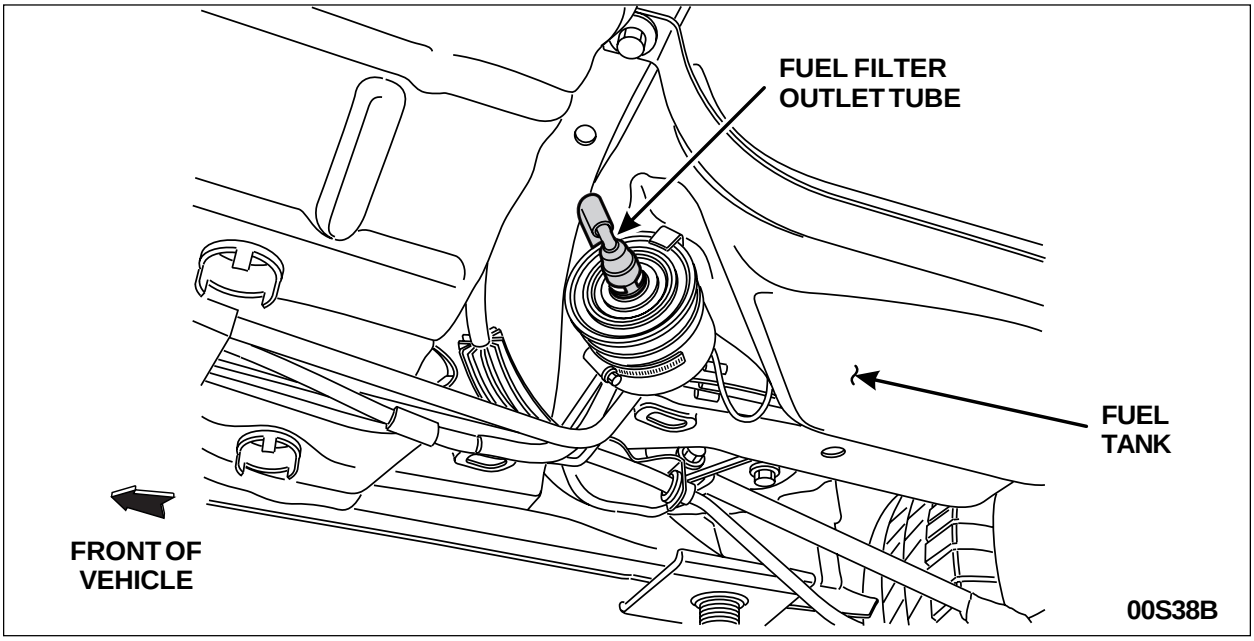


FIGURE 2

6. Position a tall jack stand at the forward end of the muffler and pipe assembly. Remove the muffler inlet pipe flange nuts, then disengage the hangers and remove the muffler and pipe assembly from the vehicle. See Figure 3.

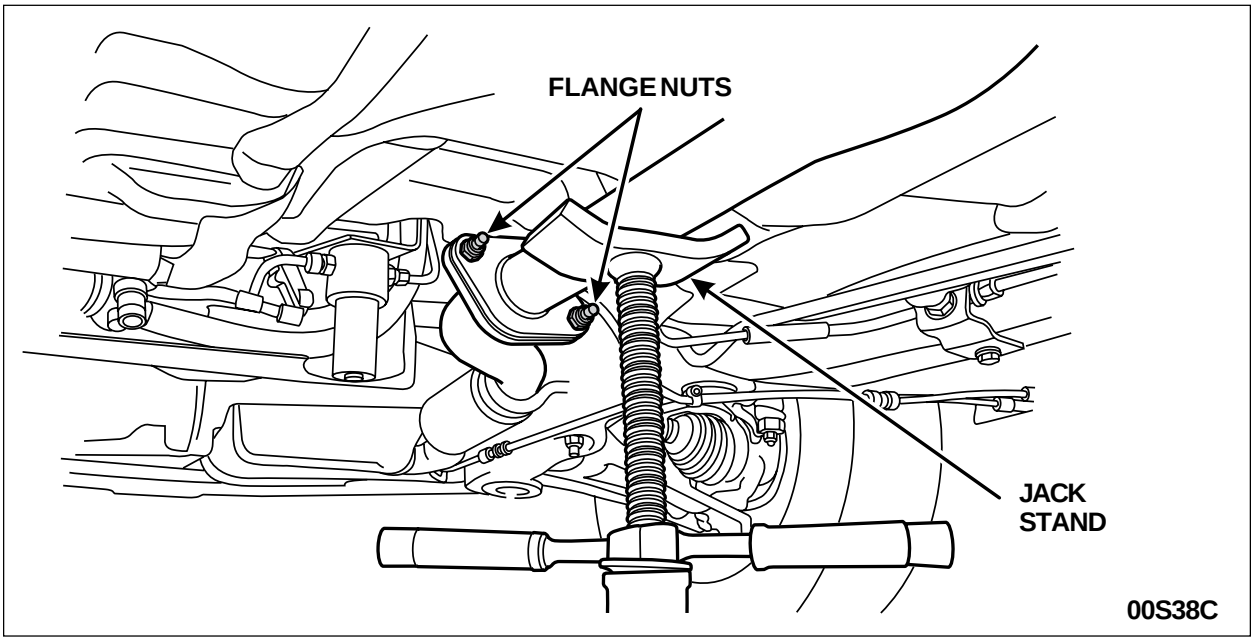


FIGURE 3

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7. Remove the exhaust heat shield from the fuel tank area. See Figure 4.

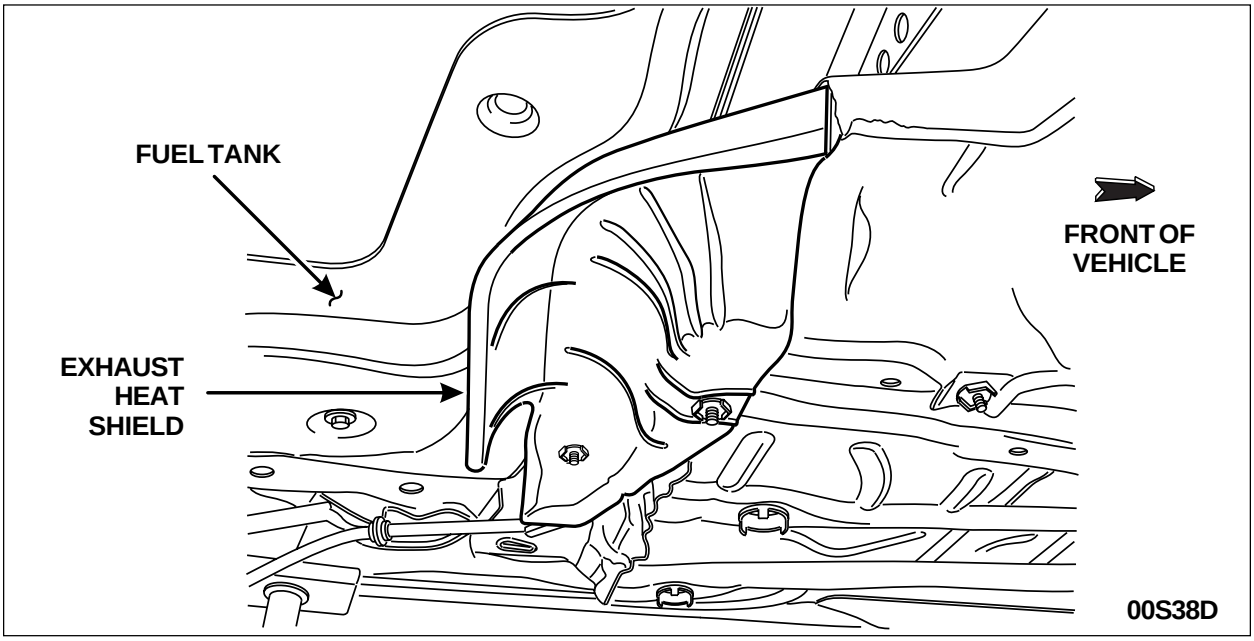


FIGURE 4

8. Disconnect the rear sway bar links from the lower suspension arms. Then remove the sway bar brackets and remove the bar from the vehicle. See Figure 5.

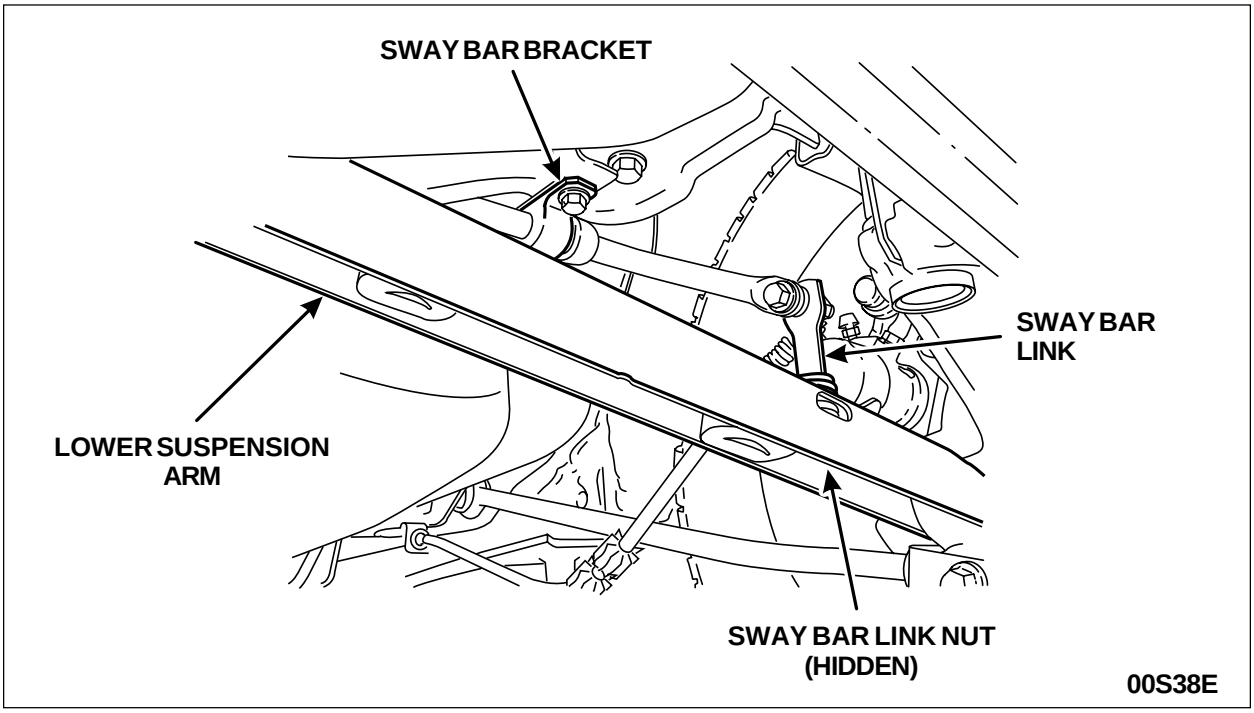


FIGURE 5

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9. Using Rotunda Powertrain Lift or equivalent, support the fuel tank.
10. Remove the fuel tank strap bolts and position the straps out of the way. See Figure 6.

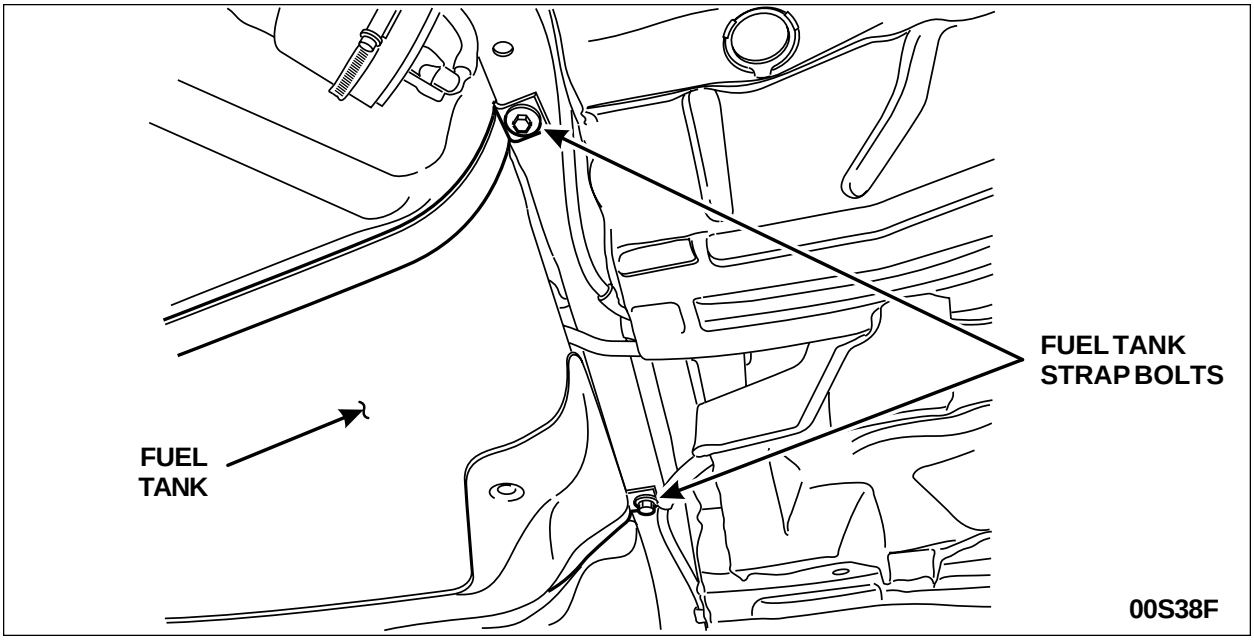


FIGURE 6

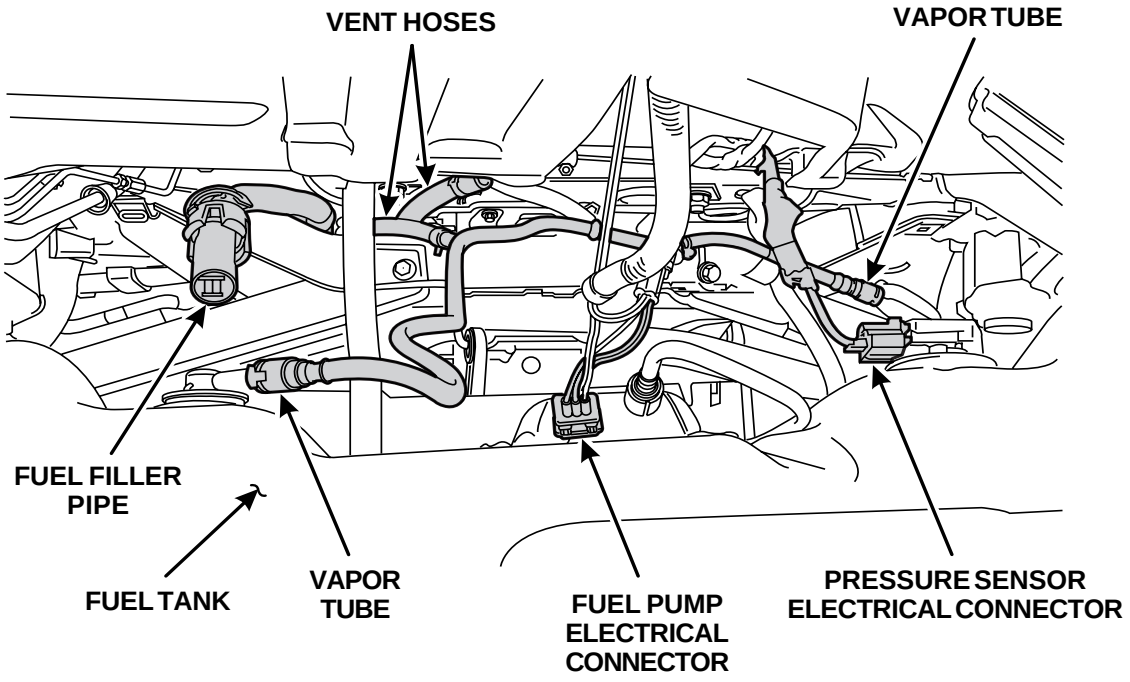
11. Partially lower the fuel tank.

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12. NOTE: There are minor differences between non-returnless (standard) fuel systems and returnless fuel systems. Depending on the vehicle being worked on, there may be fewer items to disconnect at the fuel tank area than what is listed here.

    Disconnect the following from the fuel tank. See Figure 7.

    a) fuel filler pipe
    b) fuel vent hoses
    c) vapor tube (2 connections)
    d) fuel return line from the fuel pump module
    e) fuel pump module electrical connector
    f) pressure sensor electrical connector



VIEW LOOKING REARWARD WITH TANK PARTIALLY LOWERED

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FIGURE 7

13. Lower the tank.

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14. Remove the fuel filler neck grommet. See Figure 8.

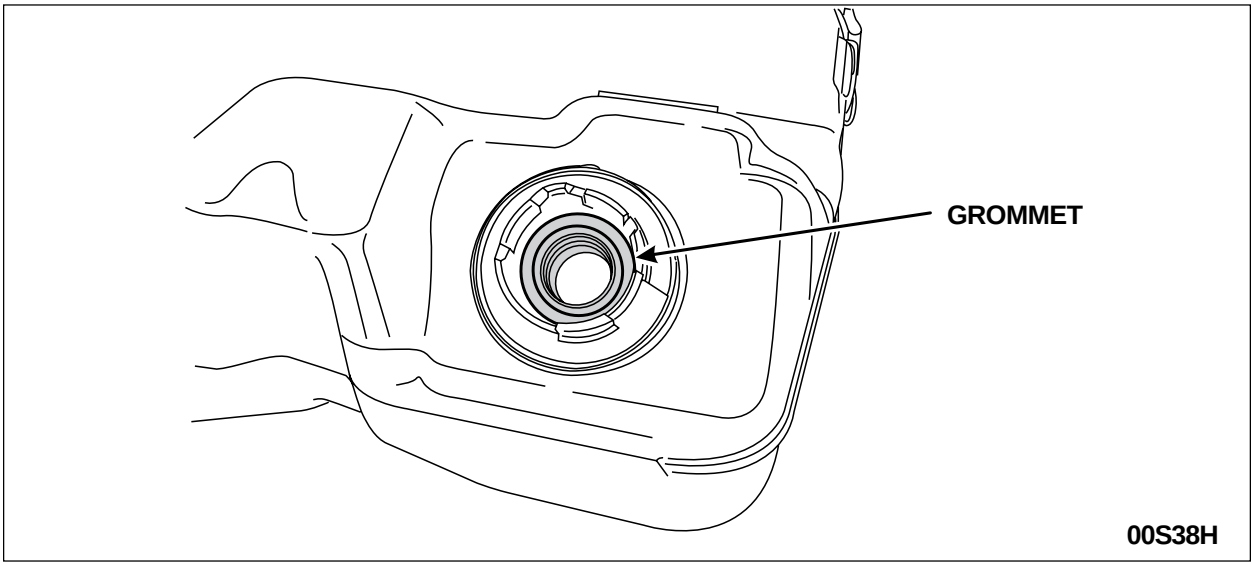


FIGURE 8

15. Clean any fuel or dirt present in the grommet seating area.
16. Install a ***new*** grommet, making sure it is fully seated.
17. LIGHTLY LUBRICATE THE GROMMET AND THE FUEL FILLER PIPE WITH PETROLEUM JELLY TO HELP EASE FILLER PIPE REINSTALLATION. Make sure the inner fuel tank filler seal is in position and that it does not become dislodged during fuel tank filler pipe installation.
18. Partially raise the tank and connect the following:
    a) pressure sensor electrical connector
    b) fuel pump module electrical connector
    c) fuel return line from the fuel pump module
    d) vapor tube (2 connections)
    e) fuel vent hoses
    f) fuel filler pipe
19. Raise the tank to the installed position and secure the tank straps. Tighten the strap bolts to 35 Nm (26 lb-ft).
20. Install the sway bar. Tighten the bracket bolts to the crossmember to 23 Nm (17 lb-ft). Tighten the link nuts to the lower arms to 35 Nm (26 lb-ft).
21. Install the exhaust heat shield.
22. Install the exhaust muffler and pipe assembly. Replace the gasket if necessary. Tighten the muffler inlet pipe flange nuts to 47 Nm (35 lb-ft).
23. Connect the fuel filter outlet tube.
24. Lower the vehicle.
25. Refill the fuel tank with the removed fuel.
26. Connect the battery ground cable and remove the memory saver.

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